

Promoting a Culture of Reading From Pune to New Delhi and Beyond

Making books accessible in every corner of the country through book fairs and book promotion campaigns lies at the heart of NBT's mission to promote and nurture a lifelong culture of reading across all age groups. NBT is bringing books into public life with initiatives ranging from the recent Pune Book Festival, the internationally successful Frankfurt Book Fair to the upcoming New Delhi World Book Fair.



Shri Devendra Fadnavis, Hon'ble Chief Minister of Maharashtra, at Pune Book Festival 2025.

Pune Book Festival Sets New Benchmarks

One of the most significant literary events to emerge in recent years is the Pune Book Festival. What began in 2023 as a book fair has, over years, evolved into a defining cultural and literary landmark for the city. Rooted in Pune's long-standing reputation as an intellectual hub, the Festival has expanded in scale and public engagement.

The inaugural edition in 2023 laid the foundation by bringing together publishers, authors and readers in unprecedented numbers. The momentum continued in 2024, when the festival broadened its scope to include cultural programs, including a children's film festival, workshops, competitions and book launches.



The Pune Book Festival has created 12 Guinness World Records for reading.

In the days leading up to the festival's third edition in 2025, the reading campaign "Silence… Pune is Reading" (शांतता. ..पुणेकर वाचक आहेत!) returned to the city and transformed metro stations, workplaces, schools and offices into quiet reading corners. Lakhs of citizens, including students, professionals, government employees and public figures, pressed pause on their routines to read silently for an hour.

This year, the festival hosted over 900 book stalls, a children's pavilion, evening cultural performances and a six-day Pune Literature Festival featuring nationally and internationally recognised voices including Booker Prize winner Banu Mushtaq, Hon'ble Minister of External Affairs Shri S. Jaishankar, Grammy-winning artist Ricky Kej, and eminent actor and filmmaker Sachin Pilgaonkar.

Over the years, it has also emerged as a Guinness World Record-setting event. In 2023, it achieved records for the most parents reading to their children simultaneously, the largest book word, the largest book sentence, and the largest online video album of people reading aloud. The momentum continued in 2024 with new



Shri S Jaishankar, Hon'ble Minister of Foreign Affairs in conversation with NBT Director Shri Yuvraj Malik at Pune Book Festival



Shri Arif Mohammed Khan, Hon'ble Governor of Bihar, inaugurated Pune Lit Fest 2025.



Group Captain Shubhanshu Shukla in conversation with NBT Director Shri Yuvraj Malik at Pune Book Festival 2025.